



ThePatch.News

A seasonal public journal
& digital commons

Governance & Operations Overview

What It Is?

PatchRoot.org is a seasonal journal and public digital commons. It serves as an independent, collaborative space for regenerative storytelling, documentation, and citizen-science inquiry.

Though rooted in the EPiD Studios and AgroReGenerations ecosystem, PatchRoot.org operates as its own entity, working within a Stewardship Circle of collaborative leadership to amplify the work of those driving regenerative initiatives — farmers, land stewards, technologists, builders, educators, artists, policymakers, youth leaders, and others across all regions — actively contributing to a more regenerative, equitable, and aligned planet.

Timeline & Launch Context

Germination:

Concept developed and structure conceived.

Autumn 2025 (Ongoing):

Final eight panelists being confirmed, as well as our first Stewardship Circle of collective leadership.

Spring (2025)

Summer (2025)

Autumn(2025)

Summer(2026)

Summer Solstice (June 21 2025) - Autumn Equinox (September 21 2025):

Ongoing refinement and content development; establishing the first group of panelists and nominating organizations.

Summer Solstice (June 21, 2026)

Publication of Issue #1 – Summer Solstice Launch Issue, featuring the first Recognition Awards.



Principles & Positioning

PatchRoot.org is:

- ❖ Volunteer-driven and non-commercial
- ❖ Donation-supported and operated at cost
- ❖ Open-source and transparent in all processes
- ❖ Focused on citizen science, documentation, regenerative storytelling, and amplifying stories globally.

There are no advertisements, pay-to-play arrangements, monetization of submissions, or commercial sponsorship of the journal itself — though values-aligned sponsors are welcome to support our mission.

There will be no paid subscriptions. This journal will remain digital and freely accessible to anyone who wishes to read it. We will not crowdfund or engage in spam-based outreach, but hope instead that it will grow organically through merit and the same principles embodied by the stories and people we seek to highlight within its digital pages.



Recognition Awards & Microgrants

Eight (8) Recognition Awards are granted each season from a pool of maximum of 42 nominations, with a total microgrant allocation of **\$1,000 USD** per issue, distributed as follows:



1 Core Award

- ★ ~2,000-word feature article
- ★ \$500 USD microgrant



Mycelium Awards (3)

- ★ 300–500-word profiles
- ★ \$100 USD microgrant each



Microbe Awards (4)

- ★ spotlight quotes
- ★ \$50 USD each

Nominations are coordinated internally through the panel, participating organizations, and the Stewardship Circle.



Nomination & Voting Process

- ❖ A maximum of 42 nominees per issue.
- ❖ Nominations submitted by regenerative-focused and established organizations to ensure a diverse pool of candidates.
 - For example: up to 8 organizations may each nominate 4 individuals (32 total).
 - Peer panelists may nominate 1 or 2 each.
 - The editorial team and Stewardship Circle may add further nominations as needed to reach a maximum of 42.
- ❖ Each issue's nomination and voting timeline will be published within the current governance document for full transparency.
- ❖ Eight peer panelists review and vote anonymously using AI-assisted summaries, project links, and a digital voting mechanism in two tiers.
- ❖ Selection occurs in two rounds to ensure diversity and fairness.
- ❖ No ranking systems, click-based metrics, or external voting are used to determine outcomes. Final decisions are merit-based and affirmed through the panel process.
- ❖ Awardees are invited to serve as panelists in the following issue and have an open invitation to participate in the Stewardship Circle.



The Stewardship Circle

All panelists and awardees are invited to join the Stewardship Circle — a collaborative, co-leadership collective that advises future cycles, nominations, themes, and content. It is non-hierarchical by design, with participation remaining fluid and self-directed according to each member's capacity and interest. Current stewards for each publication will be listed publicly for transparency.

Microgrant Funding Logic

- ❖ Target per issue: \$1,000 USD in microgrants.
- ❖ Funded through private donations with transparent, publicly verifiable wallets.
- ❖ Our immediate goal is to raise approximately \$4,000 USD to cover the first three issues (a nine-month birth and harvest cycle) plus a \$1,000 contingency for basic operations (server, domains, and layout costs).
- ❖ When that target is reached, the next priority is to formalize the legal structure for PatchRoot.org and secure additional issues in advance.
- ❖ All funds will be held transparently and viewable through public wallets.
- ❖ This model and journal are not intended to be revenue-generating at any time.



Legal Positioning

- ❖ All participation is voluntary.
- ❖ Microgrants constitute recognition, not employment.
- ❖ Donations are supportive contributions, not investments.
- ❖ NFTs or digital badges are symbolic and non-speculative.
- ❖ Required disclaimers remain unchanged.

Status Update (as of October 2025)

- ❖ Eight panelists being confirmed and to be made public
- ❖ Stewardship Circle initiated and growing
- ❖ 42-nominee structure finalized
- ❖ Governance framework to be publicly linked on PatchRoot.org
- ❖ First complete issue in progress for Winter Solstice (December 21 2025)

Summary

PatchRoot.org is finalizing its first complete issue while refining its governance to make every step of the process — from nomination to selection — as public, transparent, and merit-based as possible. Our aim is to amplify the voices and projects most in need of recognition and support while maintaining open access and collective stewardship as core principles.

Thank you to all who have contributed time, insight, and encouragement so far. If this resonates with you or you would like to participate or support our work in any way, please contact us at: commons@patchroot.org

